SENSay

# SENSay Connect: a guide for AAC services

Evidence from the device you already chose

| | |
|---|---|
| **Audience** | AAC services and teams whose children use TD Snap, Grid 3 and other devices |
| **Version** | October 2026 |
| **Website** | sensay.uk |
| **Contact** | hello@sensay.uk |

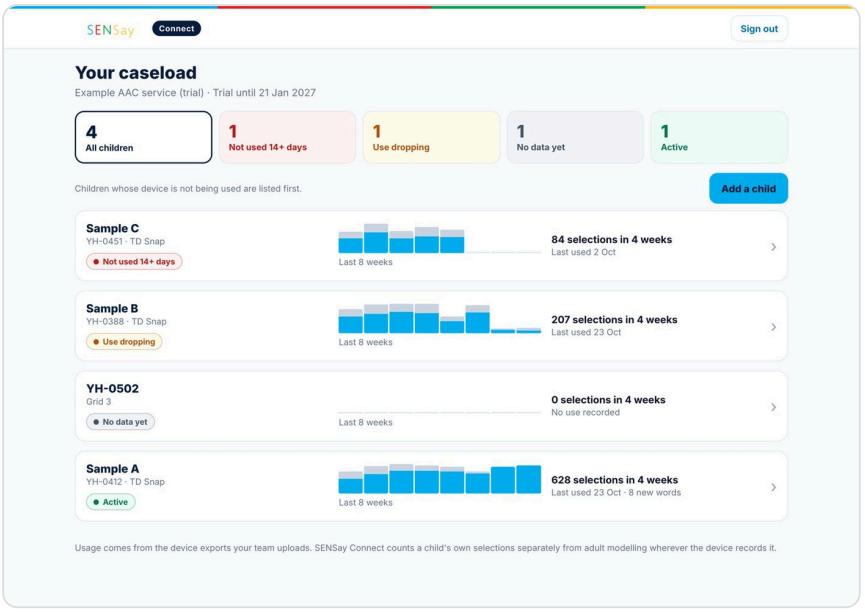
## 1 What Connect is

TD Snap already records how a child uses their device, and myTobiiDynavox shows it day by day, one child at a time. Connect takes that same data and does what a busy team has no time to do by hand: keeps it, compares it over months, looks across the whole caseload, and tells you who needs you this week.

Connect has no communication board of its own and nothing for the child to use. Each month, someone on your team downloads each child's usage report from myTobiiDynavox and uploads it to Connect.

| | myTobiiDynavox usage reports | SENSay Connect |
|---|---|---|
| View | One child, the days you pick | Your whole caseload on one page |
| Over time | The days you choose to look at | Every upload kept, growth shown month by month |
| Who needs attention | You find out by looking | A list each week: stopped, dropping, target words unused, upload out of date |
| Child or adult | Usage and modelling counts | The child's own use kept separate from modelling, as a share you can track |
| Goals | Not covered | Each target word, how often used and when first used |
| Evidence | A spreadsheet to download | A paragraph for each review and a service summary for managers and commissioners |
| Other devices | TD Snap only | TD Snap, Grid 3, PRC-Saltillo devices, CoughDrop, Speak for Yourself and spreadsheets on one caseload |

| Connect is | Connect is not |
|---|---|
| A way to see how devices are being used across your caseload | A communication app or a replacement for TD Snap |
| Evidence for reviews, goals, EHCPs and reports to commissioners | A judgement on which device a child should have |
| An early warning that a device may be going unused | A diagnosis or a clinical decision |
| Something your team controls: you choose the children and the uploads | A way to contact your families or your children |




The Connect caseload: children on TD Snap and Grid 3, with who needs you this week

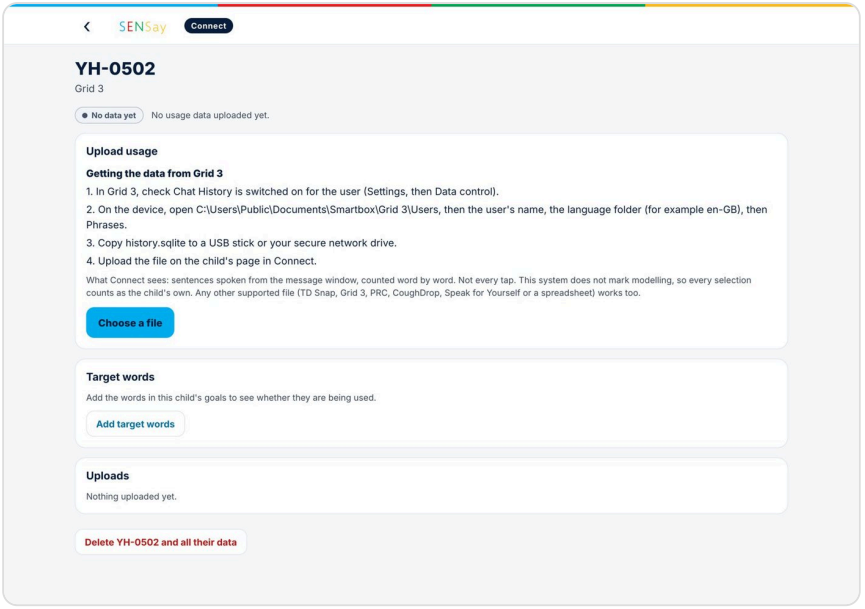
## 2 What your team gets

The questions services are asked, and what Connect shows for each:

| The question | What Connect shows |
|---|---|
| Who should we see this week? | A "Needs you this week" list: children who have stopped, whose use has halved, whose target words are unused, or whose upload is out of date |
| Is the device being used? | For every child: Active, Use dropping, or Not used for 14 days or more, with the date the data runs to |
| Is the child using it, or the adults around them? | The child's own selections kept separate from adult modelling, using TD Snap's modelling counts |
| Is their language growing? | Different words used, month by month, with the new words each month; words new in the last four weeks; and how much of their use is core vocabulary |
| Are they using the words in their goals? | Each target word, how often it has been used and when it was first used |
| What do I write in the review? | A paragraph ready to paste into a review, an EHCP contribution or a report to the referrer, and a page to print or save as PDF |

| The question | What Connect shows |
|---|---|
| How is the whole caseload doing? | One page with every child, their status and eight weeks of use at a glance |
| What do we tell managers and commissioners? | A printable service summary: the share of devices in regular use, the share not used for 14 days or more, median vocabulary, new words and target words across the caseload |

The NHS service specification for specialised AAC asks services to measure adoption and abandonment, but gives no method or tool. The service summary is that measure, from data your devices already record.




A child on Grid 3 in Connect, with use and vocabulary by month

## 3 How it works

1. **Turn on data tracking in TD Snap.** In TD Snap, go to Settings, then User, then Data Tracking. Turn on button usage and modelling counts, and sync to myTobiiDynavox.
2. **Download the usage report.** In myTobiiDynavox, open Usage reports, choose the days, and download the .xlsx file.
3. **Upload it to Connect.** Open the child in Connect and choose the file. Connect shows exactly what it has read (which columns, how many selections, which dates) before anything is saved.
4. **Read the picture.** The child's page updates straight away, and the caseload and "Needs you this week" update for the whole team. If a new report overlaps an earlier one, the newest replaces it for those dates, so nothing is counted twice.
5. **Use it.** Copy the paragraph into a review, print the page, or raise a child whose use is dropping at your next team meeting.

About ten minutes per child per month. Children on other devices sit on the same caseload, and each child's page shows the steps for their own device:

| System | What you upload | Modelling separated |
|---|---|---|
| TD Snap | Usage report from myTobiiDynavox (.xlsx) | Yes |
| Grid 3 | The user's history.sqlite, from the Phrases folder on the device | No: Grid 3 keeps spoken sentences, counted word by word |
| TouchChat, LAMP Words for Life, Accent | The data logging file (logFile.txt) | No |
| CoughDrop | Open Board Logs (.obl) | Where recorded |
| Speak for Yourself | History export (.csv) | No |
| Any other system | A spreadsheet of the words or buttons used | If it has a column for it |

Proloquo2Go and Proloquo do not offer a usage export yet, so Connect cannot read them; those children can still sit on the caseload with their goals.

## 4 Are you a competitor? Straight answers

**Will SENSay try to move our children off TD Snap?** No. Connect has no board for the child to use, and it works only with the device you chose. Choosing a device is your clinical decision and stays yours. We will never contact families on your caseload or suggest they change device.

**SENSay has its own app. Isn't that a competing device?** SENSay's own board is for pre-verbal children at home and in school, mostly before they would reach a specialised service. The NHS specification for specialised AAC excludes children whose communication is still pre-verbal, so we are working with a different group of children at an earlier stage. When one of those children is ready for a specialised assessment, the evidence SENSay holds (consistent choices, cause and effect, growing vocabulary) supports the referral to you. We send children towards specialised services, not away from them.

**Do you make money from devices or vocabulary?** No. SENSay sells no devices, no vocabulary and no symbol sets, and takes no commission from any manufacturer. We earn nothing more if a child uses one device rather than another.

**TD Snap already shows usage. Why would we need this?** myTobiiDynavox is good for looking at one child on chosen days. Connect is for the questions that need every child and every month at once: who has stopped, whose use is fading, whose vocabulary is growing, and how the service is doing overall. It saves your team from opening each child's account and comparing by hand.

**Is this a problem for Tobii Dynavox?** Connect uses the usage report TD Snap already gives its users, in the way it is meant to be used. It makes that data more useful, which makes the device more valuable to your service. We would welcome working with Tobii Dynavox and other manufacturers directly.

**Will it replace our judgement?** No. Connect reports what the usage data shows. A child flagged as "Use dropping" is a prompt to look, not a conclusion. Connect makes no clinical decisions and uses no AI to interpret the data.

**Will it add work?** A few minutes per child per month. In return, the paragraph for each review is already written.

## 5 Your data

For your service, the trust is the controller of the data and SENSay is the processor. We sign your data processing agreement before any real child's data is uploaded.

- **You decide who is on the caseload.** Children are added with your own reference. A first name is optional and seen only by your team.
- **Only your team can see your data.** It is never shared with other services, with SENSay's other customers, or with any manufacturer.
- **We never sell data** and we do not use your data to train AI models.
- **You can delete it at any time.** Deleting a child deletes every upload for that child. At the end of the trial, we delete everything within 30 days unless you continue.
- **Where it is held:** in the EU (Ireland), encrypted in transit and at rest, with access limited by your team membership.
- **NHS assurance:** we are working through the NHS Data Security and Protection Toolkit and the Digital Technology Assessment Criteria, and will share our progress and our clinical safety documentation with your information governance team.

## 6 What Connect does not do

So expectations are clear from the start:

- It shows only what the device records. If data tracking is off, or the device is not synced, there is nothing to show.
- It is only as current as the latest upload. Every child shows the date their data runs to, and an out-of-date upload appears on "Needs you this week" so it is not mistaken for a child who has stopped.
- It can separate adult modelling only when TD Snap's modelling counts are turned on and used.
- It does not see what the child said outside the device, or the context around a selection.
- Status flags are prompts for a conversation, not a measure of a child's ability.

## 7 The 90-day trial

| The trial | Detail |
|---|---|
| Cost | Free for 90 days. No card, no automatic charge |
| Children | Up to 40, chosen by your team |
| What we ask | One named contact, monthly uploads, and two 30-minute feedback calls (weeks 6 and 12) |
| What you get | Full use of Connect, help setting it up, and the service summary at the end of the trial for your managers or commissioners |

| The trial | Detail |
|---|---|
| At the end | Continue on a price agreed with you before the trial ends, or stop and we delete everything within 30 days |

## 8 Explaining it to families

A few sentences your team can use:

> *"We'd like to use a tool called SENSay Connect to look at how [child] is using their talker. It reads the usage information TD Snap already records, so we can see which words they're using and how that changes over time. It doesn't change their talker or what's on it. Only our team can see the information, and we can delete it at any time."*

Your service decides whether consent or information is needed under your own policies. We can provide a short family information sheet in your trust's wording.

## 9 Getting started

- [ ] Data processing agreement signed with the trust
- [ ] Team code received from SENSay
- [ ] Each team member signs up at app.sensay.uk and enters the code ("I have a SENSay Connect code")
- [ ] Data tracking and modelling counts turned on in TD Snap for each trial child
- [ ] Each trial child added to Connect with your reference
- [ ] First usage reports uploaded
- [ ] Week 6 and week 12 feedback calls booked

Questions or to start a trial: hello@sensay.uk